

# FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN MARVEL

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Phase 3 · Film #9 (Saga Film #26)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                       |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 26 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #9)                                                 |
| Phase                  | Phase 3                                                                     |
| Real title             | <i>CAPTAIN MARVEL</i>                                                       |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"FLIGHT SCHOOL"</i>                                                      |
| Release date           | Friday, July 6, 2018                                                        |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                         |
| Directors              | Anna Boden & Ryan Fleck                                                     |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 150 minutes                                                         |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>military sci-fi</b> / <b>farewell drama</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>BRIE LARSON</b> , the only real actor to have played Carol Danvers. The Captain Marvel franchise is hers. |

| Character                                                         | Actor                                                  | Age at release |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Carol Danvers / Captain Marvel                                    | Brie Larson                                            | 28             |
| Mar-Vell / Dr. Walter Lawson                                      | Chris Evans (✓ showrunner exception; see casting note) | 37             |
| The Supreme Intelligence (ruler of the Kree)                      | Annette Bening                                         | 60             |
| Yon-Rogg                                                          | Jude Law                                               | 45             |
| Rick Jones                                                        | Michael Cera                                           | 30             |
| Thanos                                                            | Josh Brolin                                            | 50             |
| Mistress Death                                                    | Aubrey Plaza                                           | 34             |
| Nick Fury                                                         | Samuel L. Jackson                                      | 69             |
| Stan Lee (cameo: a man on a train, reading his lines for a movie) | Stan Lee                                               | 95             |

✓ Casting decision: on 616, Mar-Vell is a man, the Kree captain whose alias is Dr. Walter Lawson. To keep that exact, the showrunner delegated the call, and Mar-Vell is played by Chris Evans. It's the saga's second casting exception, after Samuel L. Jackson. (In our reality Evans never played Captain America or the Human Torch, so this is his first Marvel role.) Annette Bening, who played Mar-Vell in the real world, plays the Kree Supreme Intelligence, a role she also played in the real world.

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <b>Ms. Marvel #1</b> (1977) and <b>Captain Marvel #18</b> (1969): Carol Danvers, an Air Force officer, is caught in the explosion of the <b>Kree Psyche-Magnitron</b> with <b>Mar-Vell</b> , which <b>fuses her DNA with Kree genes</b> . <b>The Death of Captain Marvel</b> (Marvel Graphic Novel #1, 1982, Jim Starlin): <b>Mar-Vell dies of cancer</b> , and <b>Thanos comes to lead him to Death</b> . |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Marvel Super-Heroes</i> #12 (1967, Mar-Vell and <b>Yon-Rogg</b> ) · <b>Captain Marvel #34</b> (1974, Mar-Vell exposed to <b>Nitro's nerve gas</b> , the cause of his cancer) · <b>Captain Marvel #17</b> (1969, <b>Rick Jones bonds with Mar-Vell</b> ) · <b>Captain Marvel vol. 7 #1</b> (2012, Kelly Sue DeConnick: <b>Carol takes the name Captain Marvel</b> )                                      |
| Nerf check               | ✓ Carol is one of Earth's most powerful heroes from the moment she gets her powers. <b>Yon-Rogg's Kree army</b> is outmatched, and Carol <b>isn't</b> weakened to make it a fight.                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | 97%. The origins and Starlin's <i>Death of Captain Marvel</i> are adapted closely, with a male Mar-Vell as on 616. |

#### Straight from the page:

- **Carol Danvers**, a U.S. **Air Force officer**, runs security at a base where **Dr. Walter Lawson** works. He's really **Mar-Vell**, a Kree captain undercover on Earth (*CM* #18).
- **The Kree Psyche-Magnitron explodes** during a fight with **Yon-Rogg**, Mar-Vell's jealous commanding officer. **Carol's DNA fuses with Mar-Vell's Kree genes** (*CM* #18, *Ms. Marvel* #1).
- **Mar-Vell** was exposed to **Nitro's nerve gas** (*CM* #34). It gave him **cancer** (*Death of Captain Marvel*).
- **Rick Jones** is at his side (616).
- **Mar-Vell dies surrounded by friends**. **Thanos**, as Death's champion, **comes to lead him into Death's embrace** (*Death of Captain Marvel*).
- **Carol takes the name Captain Marvel** in his honor (vol. 7 #1).

#### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Nitro's nerve gas** comes from the **Stamford explosion** (*Civil War*) | MCU continuity. Mar-Vell was there investigating the New Warriors. |

| **Carol's origin and Mar-Vell's death** happen in one film | It links the two, and it connects to the Infinity Saga (Thanos) |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character             | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Shown in this film                                                                                                      | Held back (why)                                                                             | Match     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Captain Marvel</b> | <b>Kree-human hybrid: superhuman strength and durability, flight</b> (faster than sound, and into space), <b>energy absorption and projection</b> (photon blasts), a <b>seventh sense</b> (precognition) ( <i>Ms. Marvel</i> #1) | All of it: <b>flies into orbit, absorbs a Kree warship's cannon blast and fires it back</b> , holds up a collapsing dam | <b>Binary form</b> (616, 1982, cosmic-level power). Held back for <i>Avengers Forever</i> . | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Mar-Vell</b>       | Kree warrior; <b>Nega-Bands</b> (energy blasts, flight); cosmic awareness                                                                                                                                                        | His last battle with Yon-Rogg, weakened by cancer (616)                                                                 | —                                                                                           | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Yon-Rogg</b>       | Kree commander; the <b>Universal Weapon</b> ; elite warrior                                                                                                                                                                      | Leads a Kree strike force                                                                                               | —                                                                                           | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Thanos</b>         | Omnipotent                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Appears <b>peacefully</b> , as Death's escort                                                                           | —                                                                                           | ✓<br>100% |

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## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | An Air Force officer gets the power of the stars from a dying alien hero, and in his last days she learns what it means to carry his name. |
| Theme                | <b>Legacy and a good death.</b> Mar-Vell faces death with dignity, and Carol inherits his light.                                           |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>Yon-Rogg</b> (main); <b>cancer</b> (the one enemy Mar-Vell can't fight)                                                                 |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE MAGNITRON

- **Monday, January 15, 2018. Col. Carol Danvers**, U.S. Air Force, runs security at a desert research base. **Dr. Walter Lawson**, a brilliant, quiet scientist, is hiding something.
- Lawson is **Mar-Vell**, a **Kree captain** undercover on Earth for years, and a friend of **Rick Jones**.
- **Yon-Rogg**, Mar-Vell's jealous Kree commander, comes to bring him home or kill him, on the orders of the **Supreme Intelligence**, the vast living computer that rules the Kree.
- In the fight, the **Psyche-Magnitron explodes. Carol is caught in the blast.**

#### ACT TWO: THE DIAGNOSIS

- Carol wakes up **changed**: flight, strength, **photon blasts**.
- Mar-Vell trains her. He also tells her the truth: **he has cancer**, from the nerve gas he breathed at Stamford. **He's dying.**
- **Yon-Rogg** attacks with a Kree strike force. **Carol takes it apart** and flies into orbit to bring down his flagship.

#### ACT THREE: THE DEATH OF CAPTAIN MARVEL

- **Mar-Vell's last days. Rick Jones, Carol**, and old allies at his bedside. (Fury drops in for a cameo.)
- Mar-Vell drifts off. In a dream, he stands on a golden plain. **Thanos** walks up to him, **peacefully**.

**THANOS:** *"Mar-Vell. You fought me once in a dream. There is no need for fighting now."*

- Beside him is **Death**, and she smiles at Mar-Vell. It's the only time we ever see her smile.
  - **Mar-Vell takes her hand** and goes.
  - **Friday, April 20, 2018.** Mar-Vell's funeral. **Carol** takes his name: **"Captain Marvel."**
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | Monday, January 15, 2018 → Friday, April 20, 2018 (the funeral). The post-credit scene is Saturday, April 28, 2018, 3:14 PM ET. |
| Where it's set          | A U.S. Air Force research base in the Mojave Desert · Earth orbit · Mar-Vell's bedside · the golden plain of Death              |
| Relative to other films | Released after <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> , and set right before it. Mar-Vell dies <b>eight days before</b> the snap.         |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- The Kree, Mar-Vell's legacy, Captain Marvel.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                        | How it appears                   | Payoff                                                                      |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Carol survives the snap     | The post-credit scene            | <i>Avengers Forever</i> : she spends the five years patrolling the universe |
| Rick Jones's cosmic destiny | He was bonded to Mar-Vell on 616 | After the saga                                                              |

### Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                       | How it appears         | What it means                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thanos and Death at peace  | Mar-Vell's death dream | It shows <b>Death's power</b> and <b>Thanos as her champion</b> , and the one moment she's ever <b>happy</b> with him |
| The snap from Carol's side | The post-credit scene  | <b>She's the one who finds the survivors</b>                                                                          |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✓ "CHEWIE." Carol's cat, <b>Chewie</b> , opens her mouth and swallows a Kree soldier whole with tentacles (616: Chewie is a Flerken). Carol: "... <i>Good girl?</i> "                                                                                                                                                |
| Post-credit scene      | ✓ "3:14 PM." Deep space, <b>Saturday, April 28, 2018</b> . Captain Marvel flies escort for a Kree convoy. <b>Half the ships around her crumble to dust</b> . Her comm is full of screaming. She looks back toward Earth. "... <i>No.</i> " She burns toward home. <b>CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN MARVEL WILL RETURN."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: " <b>PET SITTING.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>RUSH HOUR.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline